

DIRECTIONS for questions 1 to 4: The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

In his essay 'On Being Modern-Minded' (1950), Bertrand Russell describes a particularly seductive illusion about history and intellectual progress. Because every age tends to exaggerate its uniqueness and imagine itself as a culmination of progress, continuities with previous historical periods are easily overlooked: 'new catchwords hide from us the thoughts and feelings of our ancestors, even when they differed little from our own.'

Behavioural economics is one of the major intellectual developments of the past 50 years. The work of the psychologists Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky in particular is justly celebrated for identifying and analysing many of the core biases in human cognition. Russell's insight, in fact, bears a strong resemblance to what Kahneman calls the availability bias. Because the catchwords and achievements of contemporary culture are most readily called to mind – most available – they tend to dominate our assessments. The fact that Russell's articulation of this idea is much less familiar than Kahneman's is itself a confirmation of Russell's point.

But the richest precedent for behavioural economics is in the works of ancient Greek philosophers. Almost 2,500 years before the current vogue for behavioural economics, Plato was identifying and seeking to understand the predictable irrationalities of the human mind. He did not verify them with the techniques of modern experimental psychology, but many of his insights are remarkably similar to the descriptions of the cognitive biases found by Kahneman and Tversky. Seminal papers in behavioural economics are highly cited everywhere from business and medical schools to the social sciences and the corporate world. But the earlier explorations of the same phenomenon by Greek philosophy are rarely appreciated. Noticing this continuity is both an interesting point of intellectual history and a potentially useful resource: Plato not only identified various specific weaknesses in human cognition, he also offered powerful proposals for how to overcome these biases and improve our reasoning and behaviour.

Many of Plato's dialogues dramatize the habits and processes that lead humans to false conclusions. He depicts people believing what they want or what they are predisposed to believe (confirmation bias); asserting whatever comes most readily to mind (availability bias); reversing their opinions about identical propositions based on the language in which the propositions are presented (framing); refusing to relinquish current opinions simply because these happen to be the opinions they currently possess (a cognitive version of loss aversion); making false inferences based on the size and representativeness of a sample of a broader population (representativeness heuristic); and judging new information based on salient current information (a version of anchoring). And this is only a partial inventory of the mental errors that he catalogues and dramatizes.

There's a reason why Socrates, in the *Republic*, compares philosophical enquiry to a hunt for an elusive quarry – discovering the truth about things is difficult, and simply trusting our first impressions and beliefs is a recipe for misapprehending the world. Only by rechecking arguments both for validity and soundness and becoming acutely aware of our own susceptibility to certain forms of deception, are we likely to get closer to the truth.

Q1. Which of the following proposals, to overcome biases and improve reasoning and behaviour, will Plato most likely not endorse?

- ☐ a) Interacting with people having diverse opinions while trying to understand an issue or situation
- ☐ b) Reading news articles which support and reinforce your thoughts and perspective
- ☐ c) Reframing a problem in different words to identify whether it will affect a change in your perception of the problem
- ☐ d) Taking time to come up with multiple options and weighing them before making assertions

Q2. Socrates compares philosophical enquiry to a hunt for an elusive quarry for all of the following reasons EXCEPT that people are prone to

- ☐ a) misunderstanding others and the world due to their first impressions.
- ☐ b) taking things at face value and not delving deeper.
- ☐ c) being swayed by different perspectives.
- ☐ d) ignoring their own susceptibility to certain biases.

Q3. According to Plato's depictions, which of the following is not a valid example of the habits and processes that lead people to false conclusions?

- ☐ a) During an election season, Jack tends to ignore any information that paints his favoured candidate in bad light.
- ☐ b) Stephen, a racist Caucasian member of a jury, tends to determine all Hispanics to be guilty, even in the face of contradicting evidence.
- ☐ c) Hugh buys lottery tickets because his friend, Paul, won millions in the lottery last week.
- ☐ d) Even though Audrey knows ginger ale doesn't have any effect on relieving her headache, she takes it as medicine for headache only because all her friends recommend it.

Q4. Which of the following best summarises the primary conclusion that the author draws from the example of availability bias discussed in the first two paras of the passage?

- ☐ a) Kahneman is more famous than Russell even though both of them analysed core human biases.
- ☐ b) Kahneman's articulation of availability bias is more popular than Russell's articulation of the same idea.
- ☐ c) Kahneman coined the catchword, availability bias, after reading Russell's articulation of the same idea.
- ☐ d) Kahneman's use of catchwords made his ideas more popular than Russell's.

DIRECTIONS *for questions 5 to 8:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

...The most dangerous aspect of opioids is not that they are more addictive than other drugs. Rather, it's that they are more deadly. This is because there are different classes and concentrations of μ -opioid receptors across the body — and each area becomes tolerant of opioids at its own pace.

Pharmacologist Hamid Akbarali at Virginia Commonwealth University says, “The problem is that you develop tolerance to different effects of opioids at different rates. You develop tolerance to the pain-relieving and euphoric effects a lot faster than you do to the respiratory depression.” With cocaine, death often occurs in people who haven't used the drug for a while, and then start taking it again at their habitual dose — they have lost their tolerance for the drug, which renders fatal a previously comfortable dose. Although this also happens with opioids, death can also occur as a result of the user's more tolerant reward pathway demanding more of the drug than their respiratory pathway can cope with, which causes breathing and the heart to slow or stop.

... Some of Akbarali's work implicates bacteria that live in the gut, known collectively as the gut microbiota. “Chronic opioids change the gut bacteria,” he says. The drugs cause a breakdown of the epithelial barrier, which is the layer of cells that lines the digestive tract. As that layer degrades, bacteria move into the gut wall, which increases inflammation and, for reasons that are unclear, increases tolerance to opioids.

In animal models, eliminating gut bacteria seems to negate opioid tolerance, which in turn decreases reward-seeking behaviour. Akbarali and his colleagues found that when they gave opioid-tolerant mice antibiotics before administering morphine, an opioid given for pain relief, the animals were able to withstand much more pain than they could otherwise, [because] their tolerance for morphine had decreased, and so they felt its effects more strongly.

Anna Taylor, a pharmacologist at the University of Alberta in Canada, went one step further. When she gave antibiotics to opioid-naïve mice, the animals showed symptoms similar to opioid withdrawal. ... Taylor looked at how the composition of the gut microbiota changes during opioid exposure and withdrawal. “We found it changed twice: when you first gave the opioid, but again when they went through a period of withdrawal.”

Taylor and her colleagues refined their experiments. They took mice that had never been exposed to morphine and gave them antibiotics to kill their gut microbiotas. They then transplanted gut microorganisms from the faeces of mice that were undergoing morphine withdrawal. Recipient mice exhibited behaviour that was consistent with opioid withdrawal... That the human gut has many more opioid receptors than it has receptors for any other addictive drug leads Taylor to conclude that the connection between the gut microbiota and symptoms of opioid addiction and withdrawal will probably be stronger than that of other drugs...

Q5. The author calls the opioids deadlier than other addictive substances in the first para because

- ☐ a) the mismatch in tolerance of different μ -opioid receptors in different parts of the body makes it fatal.
- ☒ b) **different parts of the body vary in the concentration and class of μ -opioid receptors causing a tolerance mismatch which could be fatal.** ✓ Your answer is correct
- ☐ c) other addictive substances do not have the same number of receptors as opioids have in the body leading to increased tolerance until fatal doses.
- ☐ d) different classes of μ -opioid receptors react to increasing opioid doses in different ways.

Q6. The difference between cocaine and opioids is that

- ☐ a) only cocaine is fatal when someone has lost their tolerance to an earlier larger dosage.
- ☐ b) **opioids are fatal only when one cannot increase one's tolerance beyond an existing level.**
- ☐ c) opioids are fatal only when a dosage causes tolerance mismatch between the respiratory pathways and the brain's reward pathway.
- ☒ d) **opioids can be fatal even without losing one's tolerance for it.** ✓ **Your answer is correct**

Q7. It cannot be inferred from the fourth paragraph of the passage that

- ☐ a) opioid tolerance and reward-seeking behaviour are directly proportional to each other.
- ☒ b) **antibiotics increase opioid tolerance in mice.** ✓ **Your answer is correct**
- ☐ c) antibiotics eliminate gut bacteria.
- ☐ d) **morphine tolerance is inversely proportional to amount of pain mice could withstand after they were administered morphine.**

Q8. The 'refined' experiment conducted by Taylor and her colleagues (mentioned in the last para) confirmed that

- ☐ a) gut microbiota cannot be killed by antibiotics.
- ☐ b) **gut microbiota in the faeces of mice going through morphine withdrawal are different from those present in mice exposed to morphine.**
- ☒ c) **opioid withdrawal symptoms are connected to the presence of gut microbiota transformed by opioid usage.** ✓ **Your answer is correct**
- ☐ d) **opioid withdrawal leads to defecation of gut microbiota.**

DIRECTIONS for questions 9 to 12: The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

...**One** reason for the relative sterility of theoretical physics over the last few decades may well be *precisely* that the wrong philosophy of science is held dear today by many physicists. Popper and Kuhn, popular among theoretical physicists, have shed light on important aspects of the way good science works, but their picture of science is incomplete, and I suspect that, taken prescriptively and uncritically, their insights have ended up misleading research.

[This] has given rise to disastrous methodological confusion: the idea that past knowledge is irrelevant when searching for new theories, that all unproven ideas are equally interesting and all unmeasured effects are equally likely to occur, and that the work of a theoretician consists in pulling arbitrary possibilities out of the blue and developing them, since anything that has not yet been falsified might in fact be right.

This is the current “why not?” ideology: any new idea deserves to be studied, just because it has not yet been falsified; any idea is equally probable, because a step further ahead on the knowledge trail there may be a [theory] that was not predictable on the basis of past knowledge; any experiment is equally interesting, provided it tests something as yet untested.

I think that this methodological philosophy has given rise to much useless theoretical work in physics and many useless experimental investments. Arbitrary jumps in the unbounded space of possibilities have *never* been an effective way to do science. The reason is twofold: first, there are too many possibilities, and the probability of stumbling on a good one by pure chance is negligible; more importantly, nature always surprises us and we, limited critters, are far less creative and imaginative than we may think. When we proudly consider ourselves to be “speculating widely,” we are mostly playing out rearrangements of old tunes: true novelty that works is not something we can just find by guesswork.

...The radical conceptual shifts and the most unconventional ideas that have actually worked have indeed been always historically motivated, almost forced, either by the overwhelming weight of new data, or by a well-informed analysis of the internal contradictions within existing, successful theories. Science works through continuity, not discontinuity.

It is not fishing out un-falsified theories, and testing them, that brings results. Rather, it is a sophisticated use of induction, building upon a vast and ever-growing *accumulation* of empirical and theoretical knowledge, that provides the hints we need to move ahead. It is by focusing on empirically successful insights that we move ahead. The scientific enterprise is founded on *degrees* of credibility, which are constantly updated on the basis of new data or new theoretical developments...I think this lesson is missed by much contemporary theoretical physics, where plenty of research directions are too quick to discard what we have already found out about Nature.

Q9. Which of the following is least likely to serve as an example that illustrates the line “Science works through continuity, not discontinuity”?

- ☐ a) Einstein's radical general theory of relativity started from an insightful examination and questioning of successful well-established theories of gravity and special relativity.
- ☐ b) **Copernicus did not rely significantly on existing data; however, his idea about the heliocentric system is based on the contradictions and unexplained coincidences he found in Ptolemaic astronomy.**
- ☐ c) **The recent radical alternative theories for high-energy physics are not as credible as the well-established Standard Model, which is confirmed by the discovery of the Higgs particle.**
- ☐ d) **Newton is best known for having invented the calculus in the mid to late 1660s almost a decade before Leibniz did so independently, and ultimately, more influentially.**

Q10. The theoretical physicists who follow a philosophy based on the insights of Popper and Kuhn are least likely to support which of the following statements about how good science works?

- ☐ a) Exploring random possibilities in science and expending efforts on pursuing said possibilities is necessary to push the boundaries of science.
- ☐ b) **Unconventional and seemingly arbitrary ideas are rooted, however indirectly, in historical scientific inventions and philosophies.**
- ☐ c) **Theoretical work in physics involves exploring the uncharted territory of unbound space and the infinite possibilities it offers.**
- ☐ d) **In the process of speculation, there is a likely chance of stumbling upon new theories and as yet untested ideas that could lead to breakthroughs in science.**

Q11. Choose, from the following options, the combination of statements that BEST captures the author's stance with respect to the philosophy of theoretical physics.

I. Philosophy in science causes methodological confusion – it leads theoretical physicists down blind alleys by maintaining the illusion that any idea is equally probable and deserves to be studied.

II. Scientific philosophy based on Popper and Kuhn's insights has led to useless theoretical work in physics and is to be discounted by theoretical physicists looking to further the interests of science.

III. The current philosophy that theoretical physicists ascribe to takes them further ahead on the knowledge trail since there may yet be an untested theory that cannot be predicted based on successful historical scientific theories.

IV. The ideal methodological philosophy for theoretical work involves building up on a stockpile of verifiable information based on existing, successful theories.

☐ a) I, II and IV

☐ b) II, III and IV

☐ c) II and IV

☐ d) II and III

Q12. A contemporary theoretical physicist presents the following facts as counterarguments to the author's ideas in the passage. Which of

- ☐ a) The limited fecundity of theoretical physics as observed in the past few decades is nothing new; the history of science is littered with unconventional scientific breakthroughs.
- ☐ b) Irrespective of the methodology used, most scientific theories to date are the results of intelligent speculation, independent of empirical knowledge.
- ☐ c) **Statistical evidence taken from historical scientific data indicates the validity of incorporating past knowledge in current research.**
- ☐ d) **The rigidity of empirical knowledge and the contradictions within existing theories cause befuddlement in the minds of scientists, hindering the development of theories and testing them.**

DIRECTIONS *for questions 13 to 16:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Young children learn individually, but because they observe one another, any group of them is performing a kind of collective experiment, enabling each one to learn more than he or she could alone. Indeed, pre-schoolers often imitate one another. Rarely do they bother trying to outdo one another. Borrowing is also typical of successful new-market innovators. Astute borrowing can make the difference between a winner and an also-ran...

The practice of borrowing runs directly counter to the conventional strategic imperative of differentiation—which traditional strategists argue is essential to avoiding the negative spiral of competing only on cost. But trying to differentiate early on in a new market can lead a company down a blind alley. A more effective approach, we argue, is to treat other companies in the space as peers rather than competitors. When we interviewed executives in a nascent fintech category, we discovered one firm that was so focused on distinguishing itself that it spent millions developing a slick user interface and proprietary algorithms..., nearly going broke in the process. Meanwhile, a successful rival pursued a different approach: It reproduced a peer's user interface and opted for a financial-analytics provider that other fintech companies had hired to gain access to shared brokerage data. Borrowing enabled the company to develop a working prototype of its product quickly and cheaply.

To be sure, borrowing is unlikely to produce an optimal business model... It won't identify the product that all customers value over existing solutions or the best mechanism to profitably deliver it. But it typically lowers the amount of money and time needed to design a good-enough-for-now offering, by treating peers as a treasure trove of ideas and resources from which a company can draw. Firms can then spend more on other aspects of the business model and on testing assumptions. Borrowing also helps entrepreneurs resist the temptation to strive for an optimal solution right away—an unrealistic and unnecessary aim in a brand-new market. At this very early stage, quickly assembling a rough prototype for hands-on learning is nearly always a more useful aim than pursuing a perfect solution is.

Of course, entrepreneurs could always borrow faulty ideas. But because they focus on how to profitably deliver value to customers, they're likely to be reasonably astute judges of whether a given idea is good.

This is not to say that new-market entrepreneurs don't or shouldn't differentiate. But initially, we argue, their primary competitive focus should almost always be on an existing substitute ... not on their new-market rivals. The successful fintech companies we studied saw their true competition as established investment and wealth-management firms. In their messages to prospective customers and investors, they all presented themselves as superior to traditional sources of financial guidance. They mostly ignored their fintech peers (preferring to "play the course, not the players," as one company founder memorably expressed it).

A focus on established substitutes helps entrepreneurs create a realistic value proposition. Peers at this stage are likely to have few users, but established substitutes are already providing value to customers. As one fintech founder noted, viewing established substitutes as the true rivals prevented his team from "worrying about the wrong things." To be sure, this focus can be hard to achieve in practice, as many venture capitalists demand benchmarks against other start-ups, but enlightened investors and founders find other ways to measure progress.

Q13. According to the author, the risk of borrowing defective ideas can be offset by

- ☐ a) spending more on building an optimal business model to counteract the risks that come with borrowing.
- ☒ b) investing time and capital into testing assumptions that come with borrowing ideas.
- ☐ c) the need to quickly assemble a rough prototype which lowers the investment needed to design an optimal solution.
- ☐ d) the shrewd judgement of entrepreneurs in evaluating borrowed ideas in order to deliver value to customers while making profit.

Q14. Which of the following cannot be inferred from the first para of the passage?

- ☐ a) New-market innovators, like children, learn from each other through observation and imitation.
- ☐ b) **Borrowing the right ideas differentiates the successful innovators from others.**
- ☐ c) **Not every child learns the same things, when learning individually.**
- ☐ d) **A healthy dose of competition coupled with borrowing the right ideas is what makes a new-market enterprise successful.**

Q15. Based on the passage, which of the following attributes can be ascribed to the strategic imperative of differentiation?

- ☐ a) It allows for competition that is cost-based and not product-based.
- ☐ b) **It is a conventional strategy which advocates against competition primarily based on cost.**
- ☐ c) **Employing this strategy is akin to treading a path where progress is not possible.**
- ☐ d) **It is effective in considering other new-market enterprises as peers rather than competition.**

Q16. For new-market enterprises, the phrase “worrying about the wrong things” could mean all of the following EXCEPT

- ☐ a) focussing on competing with their new-market peers.
- ☐ **b) considering the products that their targeted customer-base currently uses as competition.**
- ☐ c) investing in marketing their product as superior to the products of their new-market peers.
- ☐ d) modelling and pricing their product to rival other new-market offerings.

Q17. DIRECTIONS *for question 17:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

The freedom that characterises human subjectivity is manifested most vividly in a specific type of intentionality: the imagining of an object. Imagination exemplifies the power of human consciousness because it is a type of intentionality that posits in the same act both the existence of the object and its inexistence, since it “intends” it precisely as a virtual object. In imagination, the object is indeed intended by consciousness, but “as absent”, as “containing a certain part of nothingness” inasmuch as it is posited as not existing here and now. This distinguishes it from the type of intentionality involved in perception, one of the key aspects of which is precisely the positing of its object as existent.

- ☐ a) Imagination and perception are different because the former posits the object as non-existent while the latter posits it as existent.
- ☐ b) **Imagination is the awareness of something that is non-existent, while perception is the awareness of something that is existent.**
- ☐ c) Imagination is an intentionality where there is awareness of an object not present right here, whereas perception is an intentionality that posits an existent object.
- ☐ d) Imagination shows the power of human consciousness in a way that perception cannot by intending something that is not present in the immediate vicinity.

Q18. DIRECTIONS *for question 18:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. Progressivism is a philosophy based on the idea of progress, which asserts that advancement in science, technology, economic development, and social organization are vital to improve the human condition.
2. Sociologist Robert Nisbet defines five "crucial premises" of the Idea of Progress as being: value of the past; nobility of Western civilization; worth of economic/technological growth; scientific/scholarly knowledge obtained through reason over faith; the intrinsic importance and worth of life on Earth.
3. Figures of the Enlightenment believed that progress had universal application to all societies and that these ideas would spread across the world from Europe.
4. Progressivism became highly significant during the Age of Enlightenment in Europe, out of the belief that Europe was demonstrating that societies could progress in civility from barbaric conditions to civilization through strengthening the basis of empirical knowledge as the foundation of society.

Q19. DIRECTIONS *for questions 19 and 20:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

There are innovative ways of interpreting the past, and they can be magnificent even when wrong, but only if there is an awareness and at least a mitigated respect for the original historical conditions. There are also ways, of course, that are simply dead wrong. We have reasonably objective criteria of judgment, socially and professionally established, but no definitive ones. While some interpretations are persuasive and may seem almost ideal, every interpretation contains the roots of a misconception or casts the shadow of a significant aspect overlooked.

- ☐ a) Interpretations of the past always carry misconceptions no matter how ideal they may seem.
- ☐ b) **Interpretations of the past must be objective and carry an awareness for the original historical conditions.**
- ☐ c) **While some guidelines have been laid down for the interpretation of the past, innovative and persuasive interpretations reflect awareness of original aspects.**
- ☐ d) **There is no definitive way of interpreting the past and that results in misconceptions even in the most impressive ones.**

Q20. DIRECTIONS *for questions 19 and 20:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

Man has been defined as an animal capable of profiting by the experience of others. Of his bodily life this would be wholly untrue: he is not nourished because another has eaten, or refreshed because another has slept. But as regards his mental life it is true; and the way in which this profit is realized is by historical knowledge. Almost all the operations which our minds perform are operations which we learned to perform from others who have performed them already. Since human nature is only a name for human activities, this acquisition of ability to perform determinate operations is the acquisition of a determinate human nature. Thus, the historical process is a process in which man creates for himself this or that kind of human nature by re-creating in his own thought the past to which he is heir.

- ☐ a) The historical process involves man's acquiring of a nature of his own from the historical knowledge of human activities performed by others.
- ☐ b) **Human nature is the sum total of all the operations which we learned to perform from others who have already done the same.**
- ☐ c) **Human nature is nothing more than the historical knowledge of determinate operations of all those who performed them before us.**
- ☐ d) **The historical process encompasses the creation of human nature as the amalgamation of all the knowledge one gains from the past.**

Q21. DIRECTIONS *for question 21:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: *Everything impinges on everything else, often into radically different systems, although in such cases faintly.*

Paragraph: No one thing ever merges gradually into anything else; the steps are discontinuous, but often so very minute as to seem truly continuous. If the investigation is carried deep enough, the factor in question, instead of being graphable as a continuous process, will be seen to function by discrete quanta with gaps or synapses between, as do quanta of energy, undulations of light. ____ (1) ____ The apparently definitive answer occurs when causes and effects both arise on the same large plateau which is bounded a great way off by the steep rise which announces the next plateau. ____ (2) ____ If the investigation is extended sufficiently, that distant rise will, however, inevitably be encountered; the answer which formerly seemed definitive now will be seen to be at least slightly inadequate and the picture will have to be enlarged so as to include the plateau next further out. ____ (3) ____ We doubt very much if there are any truly “closed systems.” ____ (4) ____

- ☐ a) Option 1
- ☐ b) **Option 2**
- ☐ c) **Option 3**
- ☐ d) **Option 4**

Q22. DIRECTIONS *for question 22:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. As physicists, that's ultimately what we need to explain: Why does everything feel the way it does?
2. However, if you study the math carefully, you'll realize it's going to feel like a flow of time.
3. While doing so, we shouldn't be so naive as to think that things will always feel the way they actually are, because the history of physics is a long sequence of examples of where we realize that the ultimate nature of things is very different from how they feel.
4. Even though the flow of time is fundamentally an illusion, there is nothing flowing about the math; the equations aren't changing, there is just a single four-dimensional pattern, albeit a very complicated and beautiful one, in spacetime.

Q23. DIRECTIONS *for question 23:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: *The expectation of intelligent gossip is a powerful motive for serious self-criticism, more powerful than New Year resolutions to improve one’s decision making at work and at home.*

Paragraph: Every author, I suppose, has in mind a setting in which readers of his or her work could benefit from having read it. Mine is the proverbial office watercooler, where opinions are shared and gossip is exchanged. _____(1)_____ I hope to enrich the vocabulary that people use when they talk about the judgments and choices of others, the company’s new policies, or a colleague’s investment decisions. _____(2)_____ Why be concerned with gossip? Because it is much easier, as well as far more enjoyable, to identify and label the mistakes of others than to recognize our own. Questioning what we believe and want is difficult at the best of times, and especially difficult when we most need to do it, but we can benefit from the informed opinions of others. _____(3)_____ Many of us spontaneously anticipate how friends and colleagues will evaluate our choices; the quality and content of these anticipated judgments therefore matters. _____(4)_____

- ☐ a) Option 1
- ☐ b) **Option 2**
- ☐ c) **Option 3**
- ☐ d) **Option 4**

Q24. DIRECTIONS *for question 24:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

- 1. By long tradition, the agencies responsible for these resources have been directed by men of professional stature and experience, who have understood, respected, and been guided by the findings of their scientists.
- 2. Their administration is not properly, and cannot be, a matter of politics.
- 3. The real wealth of the Nation lies in the resources of the earth — soil, water, forests, minerals, and wildlife.
- 4. To utilize them for present needs, while ensuring their preservation for future generations, requires a delicately balanced and continuing program, based on the most extensive research.